opportunity to the new Chinese regime to open an issue that it regarded as closed—the boundary issue. Nor did Indian strategy allow for any serious consideration of giving possible material support to Tibet. Even if India may not have had the financial means to give the sort of military assistance that might have made a difference, it could have maintained ambiguity on this point. Deception is a legitimate tactic in diplomacy and negotiation. Instead, the Government of India instructed its ambassador in Beijing to explicitly underscore to Zhou Enlai that China need not have apprehensions of danger to Chinese security from the side of Tibet which adjoined India. [13] The Government of India felt that openness would help dispel any lingering Chinese doubts over Indian intentions.

India also adopted the tactic of appealing to China's good sense by pointing out to them that any military action on their part would complicate the international situation for the new government of China, including their efforts to enter the United Nations. Since this was of no consequence to the Chinese in pursuance of their objective of subduing Tibet, India's advice fell on deaf ears. The irony was that the Chinese never viewed India's efforts at peaceful resolution or its advice to China to be mindful of their international reputation, as anything other than deceitful. A declassified cable sent by the Chinese Foreign Ministry to its envoys in November 1950 shows that the Chinese government all along was of the opinion that India's real intention was to interfere in China's internal affairs, to prevent the liberation of Tibet, and try to maintain Indian privileges in Tibet. [14] In this first phase of the negotiation on Tibet, Indian strategy was a defensive one. It did not, however, stop the Chinese invasion. In October 1950, just as Deng Xiaoping had planned at the beginning of the year, the PLA attacked Tibet and began the process of extinguishing Tibet's independence and autonomy.